



RODOLFO CAVACO-LOPES DOS SANTOS

3D ARTIST

ABOUT ME

3D Artist experienced in creating high-quality assets for global mobile and console games. From high-poly sculpting to final Game Engine implementation, I focus on delivering polished results that meet strict technical requirements.

Portfolio



<https://rodolfosantos.artstation.com/>



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rodolfoptm89@hotmail.com



Portugal

DIGITAL SKILLS

- 3D Modelling
- UV Mapping
- Texturing
- Retopology
- Basic VFX
- Basic Animation

SOFTWARE PROFICIENCY

- Blender
- Substance 3D Painter
- ZBrush
- Photoshop
- Unreal Engine 5
- Unity
- Maya

SOFT SKILLS

- Teamwork
- Attention to detail
- Receptive to feedback
- Creativity
- Proactivity
- Empathy
- Positive attitude
- Critical thinking

LANGUAGES

- Portuguese - Native
- English - Advanced
- German - Basic

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Marmalade Game Studio | 3D Artist (Portugal/UK) 2022-2025

Shipped Titles:

Clue/Cluedo 2023, Monopoly, Game of Life 2, Ticket to Ride, Exploding Kittens 2

- **Asset Production:** Modeled high-quality 3D props and environments, managing the full pipeline from high-poly sculpts to game-ready low-poly assets.
- **Optimization:** Optimized geometry and texture budgets to ensure stable performance across mobile and console platforms.
- **Technical Integration:** Integrated assets into Unity, configuring materials, prefabs, and shaders to streamline the art workflow.
- **Team Collaboration:** Worked closely with Art Leads and Designers to maintain visual consistency and meet production deadlines.

Emirates Airline | Flight Attendant (Dubai, UAE) 2016-2020

- **Professionalism & Discipline:** Delivered high-end service in a fast-paced, international environment, maintaining strict safety and operational standards.
- **Communication:** Effectively collaborated with diverse, multicultural teams to solve complex problems under pressure.
- **Adaptability:** Demonstrated strong resilience and time management skills while operating in a demanding global industry.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

Game Art & 3D Modelling | MasterD 2020 - 2022

Continuous Professional Development 2022 - 2026

- Blender Character Creator - Video Games Design | GameDev.tv
- Hard Surface Game Asset Course 2.0 | Blender Bros
- Complete Guide to Substance Painter | Aniket Rawat
- Environment Art for Games (UE5 & Blender) | Leartes Studios
- Dungeon Prop Artist Pipeline - Blender to UE5 | 3D Tudor
- Unreal Engine 5: Building an Environment | 3D Tudor
- Unreal Engine 5: Learn Environment Art for 3D Video Games | Nicolas Bucco
- Creating Sci-Fi 3D Environments for Games | FastTrack Tutorials

I'm very happy to recommend my former colleague, Rodolfo Santos, who I had the pleasure of working as a 3D artist on two projects during his time at Marmalade Game Studio.

My first contact with Rodolfo was during the production of Cluedo, where we worked on developing the environment art together. At that point, he was completely fresh to the game industry, yet he already showed a strong sense of responsibility when it came to deadlines and ownership of tasks. He was eager to learn from more experienced teammates and receptive to feedback, and his progress over a relatively short period of time was very noticeable.

As the project moved forward and I later took on the role of 3D project lead, I knew I could rely on him. He delivered assets on time, kept a consistent level of quality, and was always open to iterating on his work. Working with him felt easy, in the best possible way.

On another project, Game Of Life 2, where we worked together to develop the Superhero World theme, he was asked to step outside his usual focus and work on NPC character skins, without any concept art to guide him. It was an unfamiliar area for him, yet he approached it with care and initiative, ultimately delivering assets that fit the project's visual direction very well. It showed how well he can adjust when faced with something unfamiliar.

On a personal level, I found working with Rodolfo genuinely inspiring. His move into the game industry from a completely different field, driven by self study and determination, says a lot about his character. He is a warm, polite, and approachable person, and someone I always enjoyed exchanging ideas with. I am confident he would be a valuable addition to any creative team.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Raquel Venâncio Marcelino". The signature is written in a cursive, flowing style.

Raquel Venâncio Marcelino

3D Artist - Cluedo 3D Project Lead at Marmalade Game Studio

March 25th 2025

Recommendation Letter on behalf of Rodolfo Cavaco Santos

To whom it may concern

It is my pleasure to recommend Rodolfo's work as a 3D artist and individual contributor.

I had the pleasure of working with Rodolfo as his lead for a period of over 2 years. It was an amazing experience because I got to witness his positivity, drive, kindness and growth firsthand. I feel very fortunate to have been a part of his career.

Rodolfo joined us as a junior artist without formal training, but that in itself was a sign of his talent and potential, as he stood out among hundreds of candidates for 3D artist, many of them with prior experience in games. I selected him myself due to the seriousness with which he approached his candidacy and the care he displayed for 3D in general. I believed he would bring those traits into the workplace and he delivered.

He worked as a generalist, and in multiple projects, and he made the challenges he faced count. Frankly, I have never seen someone who is as eager to learn, to ask questions, to improve, as Rodolfo. Always humble and courteous, Rodolfo took his experiences and all of the lessons and converted them to gains in skill set and adaptability. I have never heard him needing to ask the same question twice, because he assimilates knowledge very well. Indeed, the Rodolfo I know now is much more confident and capable than the Junior he started as, and contributed enormously to the projects he took part in.

I have seen Rodolfo jump between projects with vastly different workflows and art styles but still take the transition in stride. His constant curiosity meant that the relative novelty of each project was faced as an opportunity for greater development, rather than a setback. Every team he joined was better with him.

I was honoured to work with Rodolfo. I would be honoured to work with him again, if the chance comes.

Sincerely,

Francisco Azevedo

Lead 3D - Marmalade Game Studio

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to provide a reference for Rodolfo Santos, with whom I had the pleasure of working at Marmalade Game Studio for two years and five months in my capacity as 3D Lead.

During this time, I had the opportunity to oversee Rodolfo's work as a Junior 3D Artist and witness his continuous growth, both technically and professionally. He consistently demonstrated a strong aptitude for 3D artistry, coupled with a keen eye for detail and a commitment to excellence. His ability to adapt to different projects, coupled with his problem-solving skills and organizational abilities, made him a valuable member of the team.

Rodolfo is a dedicated and passionate professional who approaches every task with diligence and enthusiasm. His proactive attitude towards skill development, whether through mentorship, training sessions, or independent learning, reflects his drive for continuous improvement. He is highly reliable, demonstrates excellent teamwork, and consistently upholds a high standard of professionalism.

It was a pleasure working with Rodolfo, and I am confident that he would be an asset to any team. I highly recommend him for the 3D Artist position at your company.

Please do not hesitate to contact me should you require any further information.

Sincerely,

Ruben Martins

Lead 3D - Lisbon Studio

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